

Management Guide

Hibernation, Relocation and Evacuation Management



Resilience System Design and Alignment to Standards

This resilience system has been designed by Risk and Strategic Management, Corp (RSM), a specialist company expert in designing and implementing complex resilience strategies which protect people, facilities, assets, information, operations and organizational reputation. This system has been aligned to the following ISO and BSI standards to ensure it reflects the professional standards and practices of High Reliability Organizations: ISO 31000: Risk management; ISO 22317: Business impact analysis; ISO 22301: Business continuity management; ISO 22320: Emergency management; ISO 34001: Security and resiliency; ISO 22316: Organizational resiliency; and BSI 17091: Crisis management.

Introduction

This Guide is designed to support the management team in the response to either a progressive or rapid hibernation, relocation, or evacuation [HRE] situation. It is essential that a HRE situation is conducted in an organized and structured fashion, and that controls are put into place to ensure that personnel are properly accounted for, briefed and managed. During a HRE situation it is also important that management teams actively protect and control information, assets, facilities, and equipment.

Where possible a manager should be dispatched to muster points, assembly areas and to departure points to manage evacuating staff and assets, as well as liaise with government, commercial and other supporting groups. Risk Assessments [RA] should be conducted throughout a HRE situation, with changes in risk conditions being monitored and accounted for during both planning and operational conduct. Preemptive and just-in-time staff training and management scenario-based tabletop exercising should be implemented before or during an emergency, and all security, safety and emergency management documents should be reviewed, updated and tested.

A standalone document may be formed based on this Guide to shape the response to a specific HRE situation. Thematic areas may include:

- 1) Management team structures and roles and responsibilities.
- 2) Decision-making authorities and conditions.
- 3) Schedules and timelines for activities.
- 4) Communications: points of contact, communication systems and lines of reporting.
- 5) Operational facts: safe havens, evacuation routes, assembly areas, departure and reception points.
- 6) Specific to situation triggered responses.
- 7) Assets, materials, logistics and resources.
- 8) Financial controls, permissions and tracking.
- 9) Training, briefing, drill and exercising requirements.
- 10) Involved or supportive stakeholders.

Specific HRE information is found within the *Safety, Security and Emergency Management Plan* [SSEMP] in terms of:

- 1) Designated Safe Havens (secured hibernation points or shelter-in-place locations).
- 2) Primary and secondary evacuation routes.
- 3) Extraction or departure points (land, sea, and air).
- 4) Critical vendors, suppliers, and stakeholders.

The accompanying *HRE Staff Guide* should be distributed when a potential emergency situation is identified to allow time for staff to read and absorb guidance, and to ask questions. The *Critical Event Planning Guide* can be used by management teams to assist with preemptive planning where risks are pre-identified.

Management Options

Management teams will have two potential options, to hibernation or to relocate or evacuate.

Hibernation [shelter-in-place]

A hibernation is where people find a safe location [in the area or country] to shelter during a period of increased risk and until the situation stabilizes. This may be a local office, a partner or peer organization's location, a conference centre, or a government building or embassy. It may be in the staff member's or a friend or relative's home, or in a hotel or guest house.

In most cases staff will move to one of a number of pre-determined Muster Points where they will form a larger group who will then move to a single Assembly Area or Departure Point.

This consolidated group will then typically move together to the air, maritime or land border point of extraction as vehicle 'packets'. It is the responsibility of the senior manager and security function to coordinate the movement of people and critical assets, as well as to ensure that resource utilization is optimized, and that stakeholder capacity and information is leveraged. HRE situations may result from a progressive or rapid on-site emergency:

Progressive Deterioration

Where a known or predictable period of risk requires pre-emptive safety and security measures, including: elections, a religious holiday, a contentious commemorative event, escalating conflict and violence, an approaching storm front and flood warnings. A progressive deterioration allows management teams to methodologically plan and implement their risk management controls, including applying the Critical Event Planning system.

Relocations and Evacuations

Relocations occur where time permits people or assets to move away from an area of heightened risk before an emergency occurs, whereas evacuations more commonly occur with little to no notice. Both situations require people to leave the area where they work or live. A move may be localized [from a street or an area in a city with increased levels of risk to a safer part of the city], regional [moving from a city of work or residence which is at higher risk to a safer city, town or area], or at a national level [requiring people to evacuate from one country to another].

Rapid Onset Deterioration

A rapid onset situation deteriorates so quickly that hibernation and evacuation protocols must be instigated immediately, and without a staged approach – such as: an earthquake, a sudden increase in violence, rapid onset civil disorder, or the unpredicted overthrow of a government. A rapid onset system relies heavily on pre-formed triggers, management decisions and formed HRE protocols.

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Alert States will be used to govern a HRE response. It will be important for management teams, both at the point of risk and at the headquarters level, to use the same technical language during a response.

- **Muster Point:** A Muster Point is typically a localized point where staff gather to be accounted for before moving to an Assembly Area or Departure Point. This provides a defined rendezvous point where managers can identify missing personnel, as well as monitor and report on the physical and psychological status of individuals and groups. Muster Points can also be used for centralized briefings, to form transport “packets” to move people to Assembly Areas and Departure Points, account for and redistribute critical assets, and where information destruction protocols can be implemented.
- **Primary and Secondary Routes:** More than one evacuation route should be identified should a route become compromised or unworkable. Routes can be named or color-coded and should ideally be shown visually on a map to avoid confusion and error.
- **Assembly Areas:** The place where groups of people gather, including potentially from different areas before departing from an affected area or country. This may be an office, hotel, government building or contracted provider’s location. A local manager will account for people and critical assets, information and stores at the Assembly Area before departure. Given the dynamic nature of risk and the fact that the primary point of departure may, itself, be the focal point of danger, alternative Assembly Areas must be identified as a contingency planning action.
- **Departure Point:** A specific location (airport or port) where staff will finally evacuate from the impacted country to a safe country. This is usually near the primary or alternative Assembly Areas. This is the point of final staff and critical asset accountability before people and assets leave the impacted country.
- **Reception Centre:** A Reception Centre is a designated place where staff will gather after evacuating an area or country, and where the Reception Team accounts for people and critical information and assets, confirms the physical and psychological wellbeing of staff, and coordinates their onward movements. The Reception Centre may be staffed by members of the headquarters management team or specialist subcontracted providers.

Alert State	Description
1	Negligible Risk
2	Low Risk
3	Medium risk
4	High risk
5	Extreme risk

The management team must understand that international and local staff may have both similar and different risk considerations and needs, and this must be considered when planning and implementing a hibernation, relocation or evacuation:

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Local personnel often have a strong family and social network in country. They speak the language and will more easily blend into the local culture, and so may be less at risk in terms of understanding what is occurring, communicating with other people, and using their social networks to respond to risks. Locals are eligible to use host nation services but may not be eligible to use diplomatic resources. If diplomatic resources are available then they may not always extend to family members. In some instances, a national evacuation [especially by road] could present higher risks to locals than staying with friends and family or by travelling out of a threat area independently from the organization. Locals may not have passports or visas and so may find it more difficult to leave their country. Evacuation insurances often do not cover local national staff.

National Staff

Expatriates often have no family in the country and their social networks are more limited. They may be able to speak the language but may struggle to do so as quickly and fluently as a local would, and so they may be less able to monitor what is occurring and to communicate effectively with people, especially during disagreements or where they may be at risk from hostile persons. Expatriates often stand out physically more in a social setting and so may be more vulnerable to targeting during an emergency. They will be eligible for diplomatic assistance from their country but may not be able to utilize host nation resources. Expatriates have passports and so can leave the country and are often covered under evacuation insurance policies.

International Staff

Other Considerations

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Strategic Planning Factors

The following strategic planning factors should be considered by those in management positions coordinating an HRE response¹:

Factor	Explanation	
Shelter or Evacuate	Is it safer to stay in place or evacuate to another location?	☐
Nationality and Ethnicity Risks	What risks are faced by expatriates and by local staff [including different ethnic groups], how do these differ and what mitigation measures are required?	☐
Travel Risks	What risks are faced by moving people to an extraction point, how can these be avoided or reduced, and how do different groups or individuals face different risks?	☐
Movement Logistics	How can people and materials be moved, what resources are required [fuels, vehicles, water] and what needs are associated with different groups? What is the “lift capacity” and how many movements are required? Can additional resources be borrowed, hired or leveraged? Is movement security required – how is this resourced?	☐
Communications	How can information be shared if primary communications fail? What information groups exist? Have information protocols and points of contact been tested?	☐
Critical Stores and Supplies	What emergency stores are required, including: food, power, fuels, medicines, communication assets, cash supplies, tentage, bedding, and cooking materials? How can assets be procured and how can finances be tracked [cost code]and managed? Is an emergency cash reserve required, how much, where is it stored and how is it secured?	☐
Facility Security	How can facilities be secured and managed during a HRE emergency?	

¹ These can be printed off and used during emergency management meetings before or during a crisis event.

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	Are “Stay-Behind Parties” required and how are these managed?	☐
	What critical resources or data needs to be secured, moved or destroyed?	
Partners and Subcontractors	Who else is within your group, or who might be affected – what information do you pass to them, when and how?	☐
	Can mutual aid measures enhance the HRE response?	
Decision-making	Who is authorized to make what decisions and under what conditions?	☐
	Are external parties involved in, or impacted by, decisions, how, why, to what extent, and when should they be engaged?	
Training, Briefings, Drills and Exercising	What training, drills or briefings do different learner populations within the staff team require?	☐
	What training and guidance does the security function require?	
	What training and exercising does the management team require?	
	What training and briefings do the guard force and drivers require?	
People Needs	What do your staff need to move, including: family members, personal effects, pets, food, water, clothing and other resources?	☐
	How is this different between locals and expatriates?	
	Do staff need to be issued with advanced wage payments should banking institutions be affected?	
Leveraging Resources	What internal and external resources can you draw upon – other activities, government groups, vendors, partners, peers, forums, and other organizations?	☐
	What resources are available to specific persons or groups, and what resources are not available to these persons or groups?	
Muster and Assembly Areas	Where will you muster staff, either on-site or within another remote location?	☐
	How do you inform them of the location?	
	How do you account for all staff, or missing staff members?	
Safe Havens	What safe locations can be used for temporary or long-term shelter?	☐
Secondary Threats	What follow-on risks might occur from the humanmade or natural disaster and how can these be mitigated?	☐
	Note: These might be direct risks: fires, floods or riots; or indirect risks: disease, famine or damaged infrastructure.	

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Asking for Support	How can other groups / individuals within the organization help the evacuation – what support should be requested?	☐
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Providing Support	How can you support other groups or individuals also affected by the crisis event?	☐
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Reception Centers	Where will staff be gathered for evacuation from a country, or received into another country? Who leads the Reception Center and what resources are required?
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Other Considerations

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Operational and Tactical Planning Factors

The following operational and tactical planning factors will guide effective HRE management responses:

A. Responsibility: The Local Incident Management Team [LIMT] is collectively responsible for:

- ☐ Accounting for the location of all personnel until they reach a point of safety.
- ☐ Coordinating and articulating the “remain in place” or “evacuation” options.
- ☐ Managing local staff “work from home” or “local evacuation” options.
- ☐ Controlling the movement, security, and accountability of personnel.
- ☐ Controlling the movement, security, and accountability of assets.
- ☐ Sharing information in a timely, appropriate, approved and coordinated manner.
- ☐ Implementing “destruction plans” if necessary.
- ☐ Coordinating with supporting government and commercial groups.
- ☐ Ensuring that facilities are protected², and that assets accounted for.
- ☐ Coordinating with client and subcontractor management teams.

Other Considerations

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² Including designating and managing Stay Behind Parties.

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B. Coordination: The designated Muster Point Manager who is dispatched to muster, assembly or evacuation departure points should have:

- ☐ A nominal role of all staff being evacuated including: full names, date of birth, nationality, passport number and any medical conditions.
- ☐ How much baggage can each person carry – usually only a “getaway bag” and critical possessions are allowed³.
- ☐ Any specific cargo that is considered “mission critical”.
- ☐ Mobile phones, Sat Phone and/or VHF radios to maintain contact during the HRE response.
- ☐ Their own personal getaway bag.

Other Considerations

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C. Provisions: At Alert State 2 and above, sufficient food and water for a minimum of 3 days will be stored in work locations and homes. All food should be of a non-perishable nature. Cooking equipment and additional water may be required.

Other Considerations

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³ Aircraft weight limits should be confirmed before staff depart their locations.

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D. Medical: Management teams should coordinate the following:

- ☐ A list of all employees currently on medical treatment. The details of that treatment will be maintained by approved managers.
- ☐ In the event of Alert State 3 all medical details should be forwarded to the organizational medical representative.
- ☐ Any minor injuries are expected to be dealt with on a “self-help” basis.
- ☐ At the office first aid equipment will be checked at Alert State 3.

Other Considerations

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E. Transportation: Transportation is essential to move people and materials from an affected area. Managers will:

- ☐ **Vehicles:** At Alert State 1 vehicles are to be checked frequently. At Alert State 2 all vehicles are to hold more than a half tank of fuel at all times.
- ☐ **Serviceability:** At Alert State 2 drivers [under the supervision of a manager] are to ensure that all vehicles are serviceable and contain the correct emergency equipment.
- ☐ **Fleet Management:** At Alert State 2 a list of organizational vehicles with nominated drivers and contact details is to be held by the management team.
- ☐ **Mustering:** At Alert State 3 [if the situation warrants] stockpiling and mustering of essential stores and provisions occurs.

Other Considerations

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F. Personal Documentation: Managers are responsible for ensuring organizational and individual documentation is ready to support an effective and timely evacuation. All personnel are to hold the necessary documentation that will allow them to pass through border crossing points or customs. Staff must have, or must be able to access, sufficient funds to purchase airline tickets, hotel rooms, land transport, meals, medicines and personal materials. The following personal documentation will be required [managers should hold electronic copies]:

- ☐ Passports – kept up to date and copies held in ‘Grab Bag’.
- ☐ Personal and other documentation.
- ☐ Visa [where applicable].
- ☐ Money [credit cards and cash].
- ☐ Flight tickets and electronic and printed copies.

Other Considerations

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Security Planning Factors

The Security Function is responsible for the security factors associated with a HRE emergency:

Alert State 1-2 (Negligible or Low Risk)

- ☐ Managers are to evaluate the situation and review emergency response plans and protocols.
- ☐ Contact trusted information sources to aid with knowledge led decision-making.
- ☐ Review triggers for escalating phases of evacuation.
- ☐ Update employees and dependents on the current and evolving situation.
- ☐ Non-essential staff or dependents may start to evacuate the area.
- ☐ Determine a “stay in place” or “extraction” approach strategy.
- ☐ Issue appropriate advisories and encourage feedback.
- ☐ Identify / confirm hotels, safe havens and other sites (muster and assembly areas).
- ☐ Ensure organizational documents and records are backed-up, consider data transfers.
- ☐ Categorize essential and non-essential personnel – create an evacuation nominal.
- ☐ Identify a succession plan to ensure continuity of operations for key roles.
- ☐ Consider when a “work from home” policy may be triggered.
- ☐ Define evacuation transportation and material requirements.
- ☐ Review security and evacuation service provider options and contract methods.
- ☐ International staff with pets should identify kennels for temporary storage of animals.
- ☐ Confirm insurance coverages and review policies: alert insurance providers.
- ☐ Define learner groups, needs and resources.

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Other Considerations

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Alert State 2-3 (increasing warning indicators and initial occurring threats)

- ☐ Stand-up the Local Incident Management Team at the point of the emergency.
- ☐ Notify the Crisis Management Leadership Team at the headquarters level.
- ☐ Consider restricting in-theatre movements to “mission essential” only.
- ☐ Consider implementing a “work from home” policy for vulnerable staff.
- ☐ Consolidate the evacuation nominal – distribute this to the management team.
- ☐ Update employees and dependents on the current situation.
- ☐ Start relocating non-essential staff from the area and prepare for a full evacuation.
- ☐ Consider limiting, prioritizing, or stopping international travelers visiting the country.
- ☐ Consider accommodating essential employees in hotels and Save Havens.
- ☐ Dependents should [ideally] depart the affected area by Alert State 3.
- ☐ Confirm all hibernation and evacuation plans, options, and associated recourses.
- ☐ Inform embassies of evacuation arrangements and plans: leverage available support.
- ☐ Prepare for the disposal, storage, and transmission of organizational assets and data.
- ☐ Initiate procedures for possible business termination or resumption.
- ☐ Identify a facility Stay Behind Party if appropriate.
- ☐ Prepare transportation and evacuation resources, assets, and materials.
- ☐ Initiate staff and support staff briefings, drills, and training.

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- ☐ Initiate management training and scenario-based tabletop exercises.
- ☐ Engage security providers for facility and movement security support.
- ☐ Account for all personnel – share this with the headquarter Crisis Management Leadership Team.

Other Considerations

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Alert State 3-5 (threats confirmed and the emergency situation is occurring)

- ☐ Initiate scheduled and event driven Incident and Crisis Management Leadership Team calls.
- ☐ Contract security and transportation providers: confirm evacuation routes and options.
- ☐ Finalize stockpiling of emergency materials, assets, and resources.
- ☐ Internal communications are tested daily to all offices and staff.
- ☐ Update remaining employees of the current situation.
- ☐ Local staff disperse to safe areas for local hibernations or evacuations.
- ☐ Expatriate staff gather at muster points in offices readied for extraction.
- ☐ Multiple office groups gather at Assembly Areas: visas, flights and tickets secured.
- ☐ Confirm national evacuation centers and extraction routes with diplomatic agencies.
- ☐ Start evacuating essential staff or consolidate a “remain in place” policy.
- ☐ Liaise with embassies should pre-arranged evacuation methods become untenable.
- ☐ Implement the *Destruction Plan* for assets and data [if appropriate].

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- ☐ Ensure vehicles and equipment [group and individual] are packed for immediate evacuation.
- ☐ Enforce a strict control on expatriate personnel [journey management for all movements].
- ☐ Double check departing and arriving personnel rosters and head counts.
- ☐ Clear any facilities – confirm all staff are accounted for.
- ☐ The Stay Behind Party assumes control of facilities [where appropriate].
- ☐ The Reception Center is staffed and receives and accounts for staff and assets.

Other Considerations

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EMERGENCY MAPPING: SAVE HAVENS



EMERGENCY MAPPING: LOCAL EVACUATIONS



EMERGENCY MAPPING: REGIONAL OR NATIONAL EVACUATIONS

